

CHAPTER 09

Reduce the impact of each journey

Environmental responsibility starts before choosing a fuel or a driving technique. Consider whether the journey is needed, which travel mode suits it and how to make a necessary drive safely and efficiently.

In this chapter

M09-L01 · Look beyond the exhaust

M09-L02 · Use energy with foresight

M09-L03 · Choose the journey as well as the car

M09-L04 · Check where the vehicle can go

M09-R · Review and self-assessment

Answers and review guidance

Official references

This material is a learning aid to help you understand Swedish driving theory. It is not an official source and cannot replace official information from Trafikverket and Transportstyrelsen. Always consult their current guidance and the applicable rules.

Look beyond the exhaust

Your goal: Compare climate, air-quality and noise effects without assuming that a vehicle has no environmental impact.

Transportstyrelsen distinguishes several effects. Greenhouse-gas emissions relate to the amount of travel, fuels, energy efficiency and electrification. Air pollution includes exhaust emissions and wear particles from brakes, tyres and the road. Noise is another effect, with tyre-road noise becoming important as speed rises. These are different measures: improving one does not prove that every environmental effect has disappeared. Climate and energy · Air quality · Noise

Learning approach. Ask what a comparison includes. Does an emissions figure describe a test result, the actual journey or a broader lifecycle? Are you comparing equal distances and occupancy? If the basis is missing, avoid a confident numerical conclusion. This lesson does not assign a universal emissions saving to a powertrain or declare a whole journey “zero impact.”

A plug-in hybrid combines electrical and combustion-engine operation. Transportstyrelsen changed the weighting used for new registrations in 2026 to better reflect the mix of those modes. The general lesson is to understand what a reported figure represents; it is not a promise about your next journey's consumption. Transportstyrelsen: plug-in-hybrid weighting

Worked decision. Two vehicles are advertised using different environmental measures. One figure describes exhaust emissions under a test procedure; another describes noise. The learner does not rank them as though both figures measure the same thing. They first identify the question being answered and the information still missing.

Check your understanding

Knowledge check. Does removing exhaust from a journey remove tyre and road-wear particles?

Remember: Name the effect and the basis of comparison before making the claim.

Use energy with foresight

Your goal: Plan anticipatory driving that reduces unnecessary energy use while preserving safety.

Transportstyrelsen recommends correct tyre pressure, observing speed limits and removing unused roof racks or roof boxes. Driving technique and environmental awareness are part of driver education and assessment. Transportstyrelsen: economical driving

Learning approach. Look ahead and respond early to a developing queue rather than accelerating towards it and then braking sharply. Choose a suitable speed and preserve a gap that lets you adapt smoothly. This is not an instruction to delay necessary braking: safe control and traffic duties come first. If you need to stop for a person, do so regardless of what an efficiency display suggests. Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§2 and 14

Prepare the vehicle for the trip. Check the specified tyre pressure and remove unnecessary external carrying equipment when it is no longer needed. Combine these habits with realistic route and timing decisions. Avoid claiming a fixed percentage saving: load, road, weather, vehicle and technique all affect the outcome.

Vehicle-specific boundary. Gear selection and deceleration strategies vary. Do not use a fixed engine-speed rule for every car or assume every powertrain cuts fuel or recovers energy in the same way. Learn the actual vehicle's approved operation with your instructor. This book does not recommend coasting in neutral or switching the vehicle off while moving.

Look ahead and preserve room



The teal car approaches a queue on the right side of the road. Look ahead, retain room to stop and keep the crossing clear. The illustration does not specify a measured following distance.

Worked decision. You can see that a traffic queue is stationary ahead. You check behind and begin a controlled reduction in speed early, retaining enough room to stop. You do not accelerate simply to close the gap, and you do not roll into a crossing to preserve momentum.

Check your understanding

Knowledge check. Should an energy-saving technique take priority over a safe response to an emerging hazard?

Remember: Reduce avoidable demands on the car while keeping full control of the journey.

Choose the journey as well as the car

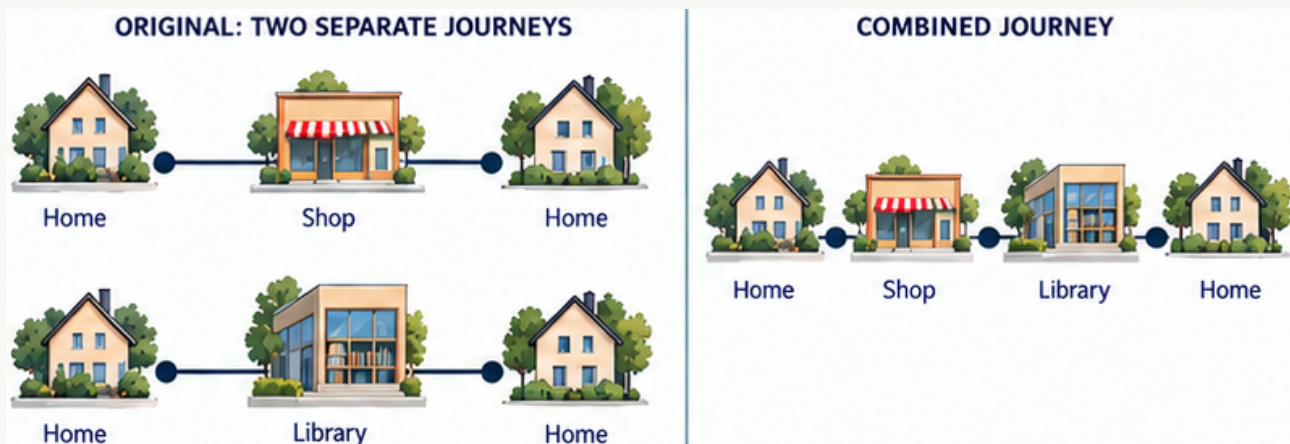
Your goal: Compare combining trips, walking, cycling, public transport and driving for a realistic personal journey.

The syllabus includes transport choices and the way personal circumstances influence them. A useful comparison recognises that people's access needs, schedules and available services differ. Category B syllabus, chapters 4–5

Learning approach. Start with the purpose: reaching work, collecting goods, accompanying a person or making a visit. Then list workable options. Could two errands be combined? Could a nearby trip be walked or cycled safely? Is public transport available for both directions? If you share a car journey, can everyone use the required protection and travel without creating a rushed schedule?

Do not replace one unrealistic assumption with another. A route may be short but inaccessible to a particular person. A service may run outward but not at the return time. A car may solve those needs, while a different choice suits the following day's journey. The exercise is to make the choice deliberately.

Combine a practical journey



Separate journeys: home - shop - home, then home - library - home. Combined journey: home - shop - library - home. These are schematic options, not measured routes or a promised saving. Check practical needs and timing.

Worked decision. A learner normally makes two separate drives to the same district. On a day when both appointments can be combined without leaving anyone waiting unsafely, the learner plans one return trip. No exact fuel saving is claimed; the decision avoids a duplicated journey.

Check your understanding

Knowledge check. Is there one transport mode that is automatically best for every journey and every person?

Remember: Good planning includes asking whether to drive, not only how to drive.

Check where the vehicle can go

Your goal: Find official environmental-zone information and determine what to verify before entering.

Requirements. Municipalities can introduce environmental zones under the national framework. Class 1 concerns heavy buses and heavy goods vehicles; class 2 concerns passenger cars and light buses/goods vehicles. For class 2, spark-ignition vehicles need Euro 5 or Euro 6 and diesel vehicles need Euro 6. For light vehicles, class 3 ordinarily permits only electric, fuel-cell or qualifying gas vehicles; gas vehicles must meet the specified Euro 6 emissions criteria. A light plug-in hybrid is not admitted merely because it can sometimes run electrically. Exemptions exist for specified vehicles and uses. Transportstyrelsen: environmental zones · Traffic Regulation, chapter 4 §§22–24a

Recognise environmental-zone starts and ends

Independent official examples. Match an ending to the same class at the start. These signs do not assert a current municipal boundary.



E31 · Environmental zone

Miljözon

The indicated environmental-zone rules apply. Check the zone class and whether your actual vehicle qualifies; the illustration does not establish a city's current boundary. Miljözon, class 1.

Transportstyrelsen · official description

Continue the learning



E31-2 · Environmental zone

Miljözon

The indicated environmental-zone rules apply. Check the zone class and whether your actual vehicle qualifies; the illustration does not establish a city's current boundary. Miljözon, class 2.

[Transportstyrelsen · official description](#)



E31-3 · Environmental zone

Miljözon

The indicated environmental-zone rules apply. Check the zone class and whether your actual vehicle qualifies; the illustration does not establish a city's current boundary. Miljözon, class 3.

[Transportstyrelsen · official description](#)



E31-4 · Environmental zone

Miljözon

The indicated environmental-zone rules apply. Check the zone class and whether your actual vehicle qualifies; the illustration does not establish a city's current boundary. Miljözon, classes 1 and 2.

[Transportstyrelsen · official description](#)

Continue the learning



E32 · End of environmental zone

Slut på miljözon

The environmental zone ends. Class 1 environmental-zone sign crossed by diagonal lines.

[Transportstyrelsen · official description](#)



E32-2 · End of environmental zone

Slut på miljözon

The environmental zone ends. Class 2 environmental-zone sign crossed by diagonal lines.

[Transportstyrelsen · official description](#)



E32-3 · End of environmental zone

Slut på miljözon

The environmental zone ends. Class 3 environmental-zone sign crossed by diagonal lines.

[Transportstyrelsen · official description](#)

Continue the learning



E32-4 · End of environmental zone

Slut på miljözon

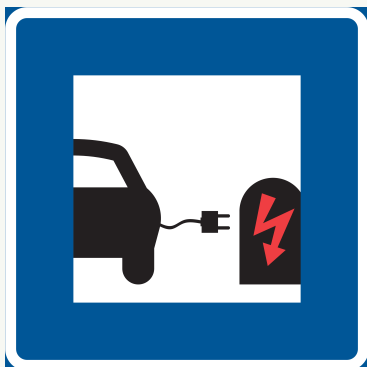
The environmental zone ends. Classes 1 and 2 environmental-zone sign crossed by diagonal lines.

[Transportstyrelsen · official description](#)

Learning approach. Check three layers: the national vehicle criteria, the current local restriction and your actual vehicle record. A national possibility to introduce a zone does not mean every city has introduced it. A manufacturer's marketing name does not prove the vehicle's recorded emissions class. Locate the applicable decision and signs for the actual route.

Charging and parking are different

A charging facility and a parking qualification are different. Neither symbol gives permission to enter an environmental zone.



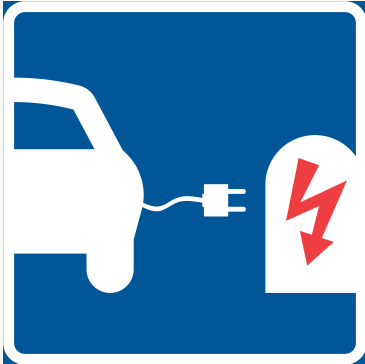
H27 · Vehicle charging station

Laddstation

This identifies a facility for externally charging an electrically powered vehicle. Car connected to a charging unit.

[Transportstyrelsen · official description](#)

Continue the learning



T24 · Parking for externally chargeable vehicles

Laddplats

Below E19, only vehicles capable of external electric charging may park. The symbol alone does not say that charging must be in progress; check all posted conditions. Plug-in vehicle symbol.

[Transportstyrelsen · official description](#)

Transportstyrelsen's official traffic-regulation collection, STFS, provides local regulations. Check whether a decision is in force on the date of travel, and whether another decision has changed it. Do not rely on a remembered map or an announcement of a proposed zone. Official local traffic regulations

Check access before leaving



Check the vehicle record and the current local decision before departure. The official E31 class-2 example is for recognition only; it does not establish a real boundary or permission for the illustrated car.

Worked decision. A driver has heard that a city plans a new zone. Before travelling, they verify the operative restriction and compare it with the car's recorded category. The route is chosen from current information, not from a headline remembered months earlier.

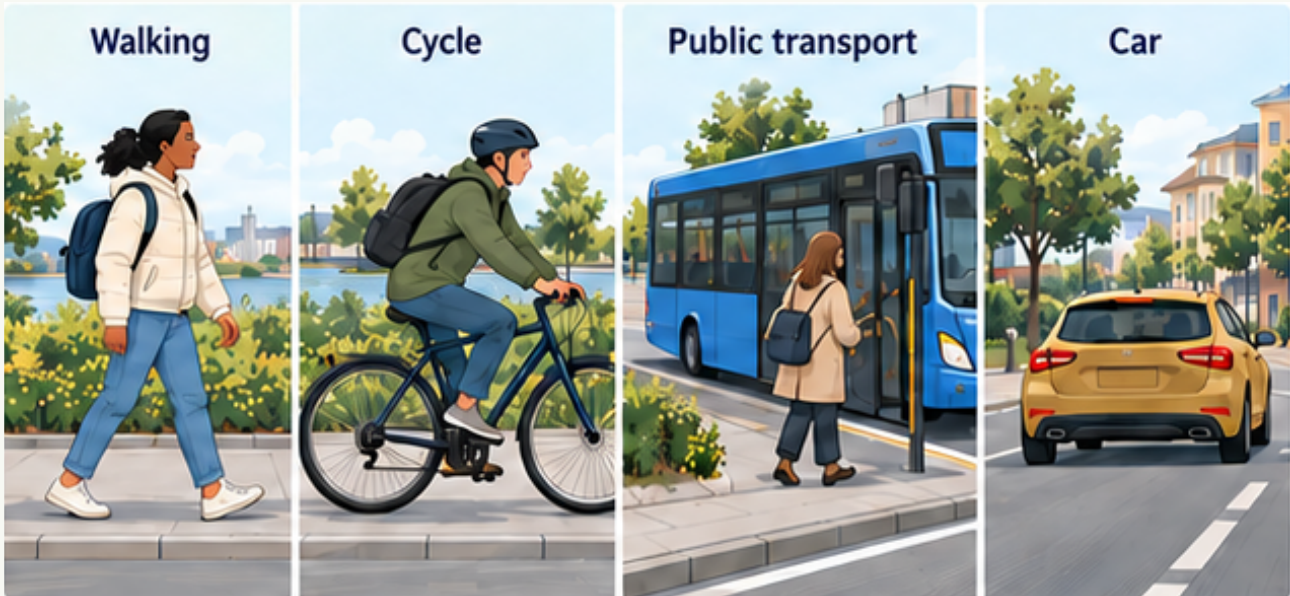
Check your understanding

Knowledge check. Does the word “hybrid” alone establish permission to enter any environmental zone?

Remember: A rule's location and effective date are part of the rule.

Review and self-assessment

Scenario: Plan a regular journey with an optional errand, two possible modes and a destination near a restricted area.



Walking, cycling, public transport and a car are options to compare against actual access needs, services and conditions. The pictures do not rank the modes or supply emissions figures.

Explain your choice without inventing savings figures.

Keep a practice record

Record one assumption you made about environmental impact or access. Identify what evidence would change your decision and where you will verify it. Syllabus self-assessment, chapters 2, 4 and 5 §3

Review after answering

M09-L01

Answer: No. Those are separate sources of pollution. A broader comparison needs more than a tailpipe figure.

M09-L02

Answer: No. Anticipation supports safety and efficiency; it does not replace a necessary stop.

M09-L03

Answer: No. Compare the actual needs, conditions and available options, then avoid unnecessary travel where practical.

M09-L04

Answer: No. The zone class, vehicle criteria, applicable exemptions and current local decision must be checked.

M09-R

Review guide: Compare realistic alternatives, avoid unnecessary distance, identify restrictions and keep safety ahead of efficiency during any drive.

Official references

Chapter references checked 7 October 2026. Individual sign captions and artwork use the verified official asset register. Always consult current official guidance and the applicable rules.

Climate and energy

<https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/miljo/klimat-och-energi/>

Air quality

<https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/miljo/luftkvalitet-i-tatorter/>

Noise

<https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/miljo/buller/>

Transportstyrelsen: plug-in-hybrid weighting

<https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/om-oss/pressrum/nyhetsarkiv/2026/forandrad-viktningfaktor-for-nya-laddhybrider/>

Official references

Chapter references checked 7 October 2026. Individual sign captions and artwork use the verified official asset register. Always consult current official guidance and the applicable rules.

Transportstyrelsen: economical driving

<https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/miljo/klimat-och-energi/sparsam-korning/>

Traffic Regulation, chapter 3 §§2 and 14

https://www.riksdagen.se/sv/dokument-och-lagar/dokument/svensk-forfattningssamling/trafikforordning-19981276_sfs-1998-1276/

Category B syllabus, chapters 4–5

https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/TSFS/TSFS%202011_20.pdf

Transportstyrelsen: environmental zones

<https://www.transportstyrelsen.se/sv/vagtrafik/miljo/miljozoner/>

Official references

Chapter references checked 7 October 2026. Individual sign captions and artwork use the verified official asset register. Always consult current official guidance and the applicable rules.

Official local traffic regulations

<https://rdt.transportstyrelsen.se/rdt/Default.aspx?UseStfs=1>

Road-sign illustrations: Transportstyrelsen. Each reference example links to its official description. Swedish names are official; English labels and explanations are editorial translations. Road scenes are simplified illustrations, not to scale.